Curriculum Vitae

Olivia Vruwink, MS CCC-SLP
164 Pillsbury Drive SE Minneapolis, MN 55455
vruwi005@umn.edu | oliviavruwink@gmail.com
https://orcid.org/0000-0001-9112-1147 | https://oliviavruwink.github.io/

EDUCATION

PhD, University of Minnesota — Expected 2027
Speech-Language-Hearing Sciences
Dissertation: Purpose in Life & Well-Being Among Care Partners of Individuals with Traumatic Brain Injury–Related Cognitive-Communication Disorders: A Mixed-Methods Investigation

MS, Minnesota State University, Mankato — 2019
Communication Disorders

BS, University of Wisconsin-Eau Claire — 2017
Major: Communication Sciences & Disorders
Minor: Latin American Studies

CLINICAL EXPERIENCE

Speech-Language Pathologist
St. Francis Area Schools (Minnesota) — 2020–2022
Black River Falls School District (Wisconsin) — 2019–2020

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor of Record

- Neurogenic Communication Disorders (SHS 451) — Fall 2026
  - Washington State University
- Language and Cognitive Disorders in Adults (SLHS 5605) — March–May 2025
  - University of Minnesota
- Introduction to Neuroscience of Human Communication (SLHS 4301) — Fall 2024
  - University of Minnesota

Teaching Assistant | University of Minnesota

- Introduction to the Neuroscience of Human Communication (SLHS 4301) — Fall 2022, 2023, 2025, 2026
  - Instructors of Record: Natalie Covington, PhD CCC-SLP; Christopher Apfelbach, PhD CCC-SLP
- Rate Your World: Quantifying Judgments of Human Behavior (SLHS 1302) — Spring 2025
  - Instructor of Record: Yang Zhang, PhD
- The Sense of Hearing (SLHS 3306) — Spring 2023, 2024
  - Instructor of Record: Robert Schlauch, PhD
- Anatomy & Physiology of the Speech & Hearing Mechanisms (SLHS 3302) — Fall 2023
  - Instructor of Record: Yang Zhang, PhD
- Capstone Project in Speech-Language-Hearing Sciences (SLHS 3402W) — Spring 2023
  - Instructor of Record: Jayanthi Sasisekaran, PhD
- Speech Science (SLHS 3305W) — Fall 2022
  - Instructor of Record: Peter Watson, PhD

Guest Lectures

- Language and Cognitive Disorders in Adults (SLHS 5605) — April 2026
  - University of Minnesota
  - Instructor of Record: Danielle Schneeman, MS CCC-SLP
  - Topic: Traumatic Brain Injury & Care Partner Well-being
- Neurogenic Communication Disorders (SHS 451) — November 2025
  - Washington State University
  - Instructor of Record: Amy Kemp, PhD CCC-SLP
  - Topic: Living with Purpose after Traumatic Brain Injury
- Introduction to Augmentative and Alternative Communication (SLHS 5606) — Spring 2025
  - University of Minnesota
  - Instructor of Record: Katlyn McGrattan, PhD CCC-SLP
  - Topic: School-Based AAC Parts I & II
- Introduction to the Neuroscience of Human Communication (SLHS 4301) — Fall 2022, 2023
  - University of Minnesota
  - Instructor of Record: Natalie Covington, PhD CCC-SLP
  - Topics: Resting Membrane Potential & Overview to Speech & Voice

PEDAGOGICAL TRAINING & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Community-Engaged Learning: Internal Structures, Best Practices, Syllabus Design — In Progress
Graduate Engagement Micro-credential at Texas Tech University

Teaching in Higher Education, GRAD 8101 (3 credits) — Spring 2023
University of Minnesota | Grade: A

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Doctoral Student Researcher — 2022–Present
Trajectories after Brain Injury Lab: University of Minnesota
PI & Advisor: Natalie Covington, PhD CCC-SLP

Graduate Student Researcher — 2017–2018
Rec N' Read: Minnesota State University, Mankato
Advisor: Megan Mahowald, PhD CCC-SLP

Undergraduate Student Researcher — 2016–2017
Scholarship of Teaching & Learning Lab: UW-Eau Claire
Advisor: Jerry Hoepner, PhD CCC-SLP

SCHOLARLY CONTRIBUTIONS

Peer-Reviewed Publications

Vruwink, O., & Covington, N. V. (submitted). Communication by the campfire: An overview of therapeutic camps in speech-language pathology. *Seminars in Speech and Language.*

Vruwink, O., Gregory, S. K., Rawls, E., Willis, C., & Kemp, A. M. (2026). Stories that speak back: Participatory dissemination through art after brain injury. *Journal of Participatory Research Methods*, *7*(2).

O'Brien, K. H., Pei, Y., **Vruwink, O.**, Becker, N., Klukas, C., & Covington, N. V. (2026). Reading after traumatic brain injury: Shifts in engagement, purpose, and format across everyday material types. *American Journal of Speech-Language Pathology*.

Covington, N. V., Friedman, S. E., Klukas, C., Becker, N., **Vruwink, O.**, & O'Brien, K. H. (2026). Open notes in brain injury rehabilitation part 2: Provider and patient preferences for artificial intelligence solutions. *Archives of Physical Medicine and Rehabilitation*, *107*(5), 843–852.

Covington, N. V., Friedman, S. E., Becker, N., Klukas, C., **Vruwink, O.**, & O'Brien, K. H. (2026). Open notes in brain injury rehabilitation part 1: Contrasting perspectives of patients and providers. *Archives of Physical Medicine and Rehabilitation*, *107*(5), 831–842.

Covington, N. V., & **Vruwink, O.** (2025). ChatGPT in undergraduate education: Performance of GPT-3.5 and identification of AI-generated text in introductory neuroscience. *International Journal of Artificial Intelligence in Education*, 35(2), 627–650.

Covington, N. V., **Vruwink, O.**, & Radomski, M. V. (2025). Purpose in life after brain injury: Expanding the focus and impact of interdisciplinary rehabilitation. *American Journal of Speech-Language Pathology*, *34*(3S), 1843–1854.

Kemp, A. M., **Vruwink, O.**, & O'Brien, K. H. (2025). Finding a "NEW VOICE to tell my story" through the Unmasking Brain Injury project: A mixed-method analysis of wellness after brain injury. *Disability and Rehabilitation*, *47*(18), 4704–4715.

Arzbecker, L. J., Blacklock, E. A., Crumb, A. M., Doyle, J. D., Esveld, M., Grelson, S. L., Gretzinger, B., Korpela, A., Kressin, K. A., Pakanich, L. M., Pulley, T. L., Nolte Rierdon, N. L., Spreitzer, K. A., Steines, E. L., Strom, B. J., Symons, E. C., Vogelsang, M., **Vruwink, O.**, Weberg, K. L., … Elledge, D. H. (2018). SoTL Lab: Undergraduate student-faculty collaborative research in teaching and learning in CSD. *Teaching and Learning in Communication Sciences & Disorders, 2*(2).

Manuscripts in Preparation

Vruwink, O., Yassa, M., Denk, Z., & Covington, N. V. (in preparation). Humanizing care: Clinician perspectives on incorporating purpose-in-life into rehabilitative practice.

Vruwink, O., Smith, L., & Covington, N. V. (in preparation). "Everybody has purpose": Perspectives about purpose in life after acquired brain injury.

Vruwink, O., & Covington, N. V. (in preparation). Paths to recovery: Treatment preferences in traumatic brain injury rehabilitation.

Covington, N. V., & **Vruwink, O.** (in preparation). Careers beyond the clinic: Course design to maximize the value of undergraduate coursework in communication sciences & disorders programs.

Covington, N. V., **Vruwink, O.**, Anheluk, M., Kocian, A., Zola, J., & Radomski, M. V. (in preparation). Participant-reported experiences of a purpose renewal intervention after concussion: A qualitative analysis.

Invited Presentation

Vruwink, O. (June 2026). *Practice case illustrating identity reconstruction after brain injury through social engagement* [Invited 1-hour oral presentation]. Saugatuck Institute for Neuropsychological Rehabilitation (SINR) – Saugatuck, MI.

Peer-Reviewed Presentations

Vruwink, O., Yassa, M., Denk, Z., & Covington, N. V. (submitted). *Clinician perspectives on purpose-oriented rehabilitation*. International Brain Injury Association World Congress – Halifax, Nova Scotia, Canada.

O'Brien, K. H., Becker, N., Klukas, C., **Vruwink, O.**, Pei, Y., Kocian, A., & Covington, N. V. (submitted). *Beyond the standard score: Timed and untimed reading measures in adults with and without traumatic brain injury*. International Brain Injury Association World Congress – Halifax, Nova Scotia, Canada.

O'Brien, K. H., Becker, N., Klukas, C., **Vruwink, O.**, Pei, Y., Kocian, A., & Covington, N. V. (submitted). *Reading after traumatic brain injury: Contributions of symptoms and reading habits to self-efficacy*. International Brain Injury Association World Congress – Halifax, Nova Scotia, Canada.

Vruwink, O., Sather, T. W., Orr, B., & Covington, N. V. (November 2026). *Reframing clinical practice through meaning and purpose: A pathway to improved outcomes and reduced burnout* [Accepted 1-hour oral presentation]. American Speech-Language-Hearing Association (ASHA) Convention – Indianapolis, IN.

Dorsey, G., Steblay, E., **Vruwink, O.**, & Covington, N. V. (November 2026). *Expanding accessibility: Adapting a purpose renewal intervention to support cognitive communication needs* [Accepted poster presentation]. American Speech-Language-Hearing Association (ASHA) Convention – Indianapolis, IN.

O'Brien, K. H., Pei, Y., Becker, N., Klukas, C., **Vruwink, O.**, & Covington, N. V. (April 2026). *Reading self-efficacy in young adult females with mild TBI compared to uninjured controls: Group differences and functional associations* [Poster presentation]. International Paediatric Brain Injury Society 6th Biennial Conference – Calgary, Alberta, Canada.

O'Brien, K. H., Pei, Y., **Vruwink, O.**, Becker, N., Klukas, C., & Covington, N. V. (January 2026). *"Read anything good lately?": Evidence for reduced engagement with leisure texts after brain injury* [Oral presentation]. International Cognitive-Communication Disorders Conference (ICCDC) – Nashville, TN.

Kemp, A. M., **Vruwink, O.**, Willis, C., & Rawls, E. (January 2026). *Then and now: Using arts-based reflection to explore self-awareness across a decade of living with brain injury* [Oral presentation]. International Cognitive-Communication Disorders Conference (ICCDC) – Nashville, TN.

Vruwink, O., Smith, L., & Covington, N. V. (November 2025). *Living with purpose: Perspectives from adults with acquired brain injury* [30-minute oral presentation]. American Speech-Language-Hearing Association (ASHA) Convention – Washington, D.C.

Covington, N. V., Friedman, S., Klukas, C., Becker, N., **Vruwink, O.**, & O'Brien, K. H. (November 2025). *Artificial intelligence in brain injury rehabilitation in the open notes era: Opportunities and challenges* [1-hour oral presentation]. American Speech-Language-Hearing Association (ASHA) Convention – Washington, D.C.

Vruwink, O., & Covington, N. V. (March 2025). *Relationships between healthcare utilization preferences and hypothetical rehabilitation treatment decisions: Implications for patient education* [Poster presentation]. International Brain Injury Association World Congress – Montreal, Quebec, Canada.

Vruwink, O., McCurdy, R., Walsh, K., Duff, M. C., & Covington, N. V. (March 2025). *Expected outcomes of traumatic brain injury rehabilitation: Insights and perspectives from care partners* [Poster presentation]. International Brain Injury Association World Congress – Montreal, Quebec, Canada.

Covington, N. V., **Vruwink, O.**, Schaefer, W., Demmers, N., & Kocian, A. (March 2025). *Personalized cognitive rehabilitation: Preliminary results of a proof-of-concept study* [Poster presentation]. International Brain Injury Association World Congress – Montreal, Quebec, Canada.

Kemp, A. M., **Vruwink, O.**, Callahan, B., Rawls, E., & O'Brien, K. H. (March 2025). *Towards wellness in acquired brain injury through storytelling: The Unmasking Brain Injury project* [Poster presentation]. International Brain Injury Association World Congress – Montreal, Quebec, Canada.

Rawls, E., Gregory, S. K., **Vruwink, O.**, Callahan, B., O'Brien, K. H., & Kemp, A. M. (March 2025). *Unmasking Brain Injury: Using art to navigate emotional experiences in acquired brain injury* [Poster presentation]. International Brain Injury Association World Congress – Montreal, Quebec, Canada.

Covington, N. V., Radomski, M. V., Castro-Pearson, S., Canavati, H., Herrmann, A., Howe, C., Kath, K., Kocian, A., Kreiger, R., Reger, L., Schwalbe, S., **Vruwink, O.**, Wagener, S., & Zola, J. (March 2025). *Purpose renewal after brain injury: Results of a feasibility study* [Poster presentation]. International Brain Injury Association World Congress – Montreal, Quebec, Canada.

Kemp, A. M., **Vruwink, O.**, Gregory, S. K., & O'Brien, K. H. (April 2024). *Art as a tool for supporting wellness after acquired brain injury* [Oral presentation]. Brain Injury Professional Conference, Brooklyn Center, MN.

Covington, N. V., **Vruwink, O.**, & Radomski, M. (January 2024). *Purpose in daily life: An interdisciplinary proposal for promoting flourishing after brain injury* [Panel]. International Cognitive-Communication Disorders Conference (ICCDC) – Orange, CA.

Kemp, A. M., **Vruwink, O.**, & O'Brien, K. H. (November 2023). *Using storytelling to reflect on experiences with acquired brain injury: The Unmasking Project* [Poster presentation]. American Congress of Rehabilitation Medicine (ACRM) Conference – Atlanta, GA.

Covington, N. V., & **Vruwink, O.** (November 2023). *Large language models in higher education: Performance of ChatGPT in undergraduate neuroscience* [1-hour oral presentation]. American Speech-Language-Hearing Association (ASHA) Convention – Boston, MA.

Kemp, A. M., **Vruwink, O.**, & O'Brien, K. H. (November 2023). *The story of acquired brain injury: A mixed-method analysis of autobiographical narratives from ABI survivors* [30-minute oral presentation]. American Speech-Language-Hearing Association (ASHA) Convention – Boston, MA.

Vruwink, O., Grabowski, A., McCurdy, R., Duff, M. C., & Covington, N. V. (November 2023). *Measuring what matters: Converging and diverging perspectives of clinicians and adults with TBI* [Poster presentation]. American Speech-Language-Hearing Association (ASHA) Convention – Boston, MA.

Covington, N. V., & **Vruwink, O.** (November 2022). *Preparation for careers beyond the clinic: Maximizing the value of CSD coursework for all undergraduates* [Poster presentation]. American Speech-Language-Hearing Association (ASHA) Convention – New Orleans, LA.

Mahowald, M. C., Krenik, E., **Vruwink, O.**, Spicer, B., & Burk, B. (November 2018). *Camp Maverick: An interprofessional collaboration to improve literacy & wellbeing among youth* [Poster presentation]. American Speech-Language-Hearing Association (ASHA) Convention – Boston, MA.

Hoepner, J. K., Hemmerich, A. L., Elledge, D., Zigler, E., Grelson, S., **Vruwink, O.**, Strom, B., Nolte Rierdon, N., Doyle, J., & Wolosek, A. (November 2017). *What are the active ingredients in your teaching toolbox?* [1-hour oral presentation]. American Speech-Language-Hearing Association (ASHA) Convention – Los Angeles, CA.

Non-Refereed Presentations

Vick, D., **Vruwink, O.**, **&** Covington, N. V. (September 2026). *Supporting care partners in brain injury rehabilitation* [Oral seminar]. Courage Kenny Rehabilitation Institute Research Meets Practice.

Kocian, A., Covington, N. V., & **Vruwink, O.** (October 2025). *Purpose in life after brain injury: Insights from a therapeutic camp model* [Oral seminar]. Courage Kenny Rehabilitation Institute Research Meets Practice.

Vruwink, O., & Covington, N. V. (September 2024). *Going beyond "Return to Baseline": Perspectives on recovery after traumatic brain injury from patients & their care partners* [Poster presentation]. Eleanor M. Saffran Conference on Cognitive Neuroscience & Rehabilitation of Communication Disorders – Philadelphia, PA.

Vruwink, O., Hoepner, J. K., & Pratt, J. (May 2017). *Portability of the sandwich modified flipped classroom approach in information systems* [Oral seminar]. Provost's Honors Symposium – University of Wisconsin-Eau Claire.

Vruwink, O., Strom, B., Terrell, R., Hoepner, J. K., Pratt, J., & Hemmerich, A. L. (May 2017). *Portability of the sandwich modified flipped classroom approach in information systems* [Poster presentation]. Celebration of Excellence in Research & Creative Activity – University of Wisconsin-Eau Claire.

MENTORING & SUPERVISION

Undergraduate Honors Thesis Reviewer
Mary Yassa, BA in Biology Society & Environment — Spring 2026
Thesis: Changes in the Daily Practice of Occupational Therapists after Research Involvement in a Purpose Renewal Intervention

Graduate Research Mentorship
Grace Dorsey & Ella Steblay — 2025–Present
Mentored graduate students in adapting a purpose in life curriculum to better support individuals with cognitive-communication disorders. Guided the development and submission of an accepted poster presentation at the 2026 ASHA Convention.

Undergraduate Research Mentorship
Claire Kubes, Dean's First-Year Research & Creative Scholars — Spring 2026
Introduced a first-year undergraduate student to foundational research practices, including laboratory procedures, general research tasks, and expectations for participation in a collaborative research team.

Lucy Smith, Undergraduate Research Opportunities Program — Spring 2025
Mentored an undergraduate student serving as a second independent coder in qualitative data analysis, providing guidance on coding procedures, software, and interpretation.

TABI Lab Research Assistants — 2024–2025
Mary Yassa, Zoe Denk, Enengy Schutt, Tara Lhatsang, & Lucy Kurup
Provided ongoing research mentorship through regular check-ins, guidance on research tasks, and support for students' professional development.

Minnesota State Fair Research Team — Summer 2024
Trained and supervised undergraduate research assistants in participant recruitment and data collection during four seven-hour data collection shifts at the Minnesota State Fair.

Graduate Clinical Supervision
Trina Vue, Jamie Kreil, Ari Natarina — 2024–2025
Provided short-term clinical supervision to graduate student clinicians during a five-day therapeutic brain injury camp and research-based reading assessments.

COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT & OUTREACH

Speech-Language Pathologist — August 2024
True Friends Brain Gains Camp | Camp Courage in Maple Lake, MN
Collaborated with Allina Health occupational therapists to co-develop and co-facilitate a five-day didactic and interactive group curriculum focused on purpose in life after moderate-to-severe acquired brain injury.

Student Volunteer — September 2016
Chippewa Valley Aphasia Camp | University of Wisconsin-Eau Claire
Provided communication support to adults with aphasia in order to promote meaningful participation in recreational camp activities.

AmeriCorps Member 2015–2016
Blugold Beginnings | University of Wisconsin-Eau Claire
Planned and implemented educational outreach activities aimed at promoting college readiness for students from historically underrepresented backgrounds.

Student Coordinator 2014–2016
Civil Rights Pilgrimage | University of Wisconsin-Eau Claire
Collaborated with a student leadership team to organize and facilitate an educational trip to historic civil rights movement sites throughout the American South, promoting experiential learning and student reflection.

HONORS & AWARDS

Leslie E. Glaze Fellowship ($11,681) 2026–2027
Department of Speech-Language-Hearing Sciences | University of Minnesota

Student Fellowship Award 2026
Academy of Neurologic Communication Disorders and Sciences

Conference Travel Grant ($900) 2022, 2026
Council of Graduate Students | University of Minnesota

Student Scholar Award 2024, 2025
Eleanor M. Saffran Center for Cognitive Neuroscience

Eleanor Swanson Memorial Scholarship ($2500) 2024
Minnesota Speech-Language-Hearing Foundation

Bryng Bryngelson Research Funding Award ($400) 2022, 2024
Department of Speech-Language-Hearing Sciences | University of Minnesota

Research Mentoring-Pair Travel Award 2023
American Speech-Language-Hearing Association

Brain Injury ISIG David Strauss PhD Memorial Poster Award 2023
American Congress of Rehabilitation Medicine

Communicative Disorders Scholarship ($1000) 2023
Sertoma Inc.

Thank a Teacher Recipient 2023
Center for Educational Innovation | University of Minnesota

Excellence in Service-Learning Award 2017
University of Wisconsin-Eau Claire

Student Staff Award 2016
University of Wisconsin-Eau Claire

SERVICE

Graduate Student Reviewer 2026
Arthur “Red” Motley College of Liberal Arts Award for Exemplary Teaching | University of Minnesota

SLHS Program Co-Representative Fall 2024–Spring 2025
Council of Graduate Students | University of Minnesota

Grant Reviewer — Summer 2024, Spring 2023
Council of Graduate Students | University of Minnesota

Mentored Manuscript Reviewer
Journal of Speech, Language, & Hearing Research — Spring 2024
Perspectives of the ASHA Special Interest Groups — Summer 2023

LICENSURE & CERTIFICATION

Licensed Speech-Language Pathologist (#518043) — 2021–Present
Minnesota Department of Health

Certificate of Clinical Competence & Member (#14132271) — 2020–Present
American Speech-Language-Hearing Association

Tier 3 License Speech-Language Pathologist (#1004436) — 2020–2023
Minnesota Professional Educator Licensing and Standards Board

Provisional License Speech Language Pathology (#1001350819) — 2019–2022
Wisconsin Department of Public Instruction